Open source projects hit by a critical security flaw

Zip Slip is a widespread arbitrary file that overwrites a critical vulnerability, which typically results in remote command execution. It was discovered and disclosed by the Snyk security team. This will affect thousands of projects including open source Web application projects.

In this case, the code snippets contain a vulnerability, dubbed Zip Slip, that exposes an application to a directory traversal attack. This flaw would allow an attacker to reach the root directory and from there, enable remote command execution.

The vulnerability has been found in multiple ecosystems, including JavaScript, Ruby, .NET and Go, but is especially prevalent in Java, where there is no central library offering high-level processing of archive (e.g. Zip) files. The lack of such a library led to vulnerable code snippets being handcrafted and shared among developer communities such as StockOverflow.

The two parts required to exploit the application flow are malicious archives and extraction code that does not perform validation checking. To exploit Zip Slip, an attacker needs to use a specially crafted archive file containing extra directory paths designed to traverse up to the root directory as the file is extracted.

The premise of the directory traversal vulnerability is that an attacker can gain access to parts of the file system outside the target folder in which it should reside.

You are vulnerable if you are either using a library which contains the Zip Slip vulnerability or your project directly contains vulnerable code, which extracts files from an archive without the necessary directory traversal validation.

The Snyk security team is maintaining a GitHub repository listing all the projects that have been found vulnerable to Zip Slip and have been responsibly disclosed, including fix dates and versions. The repository is open to contributions from the wider community to ensure it maintains the most up-to-date status.

It allows the user to manage container images more efficiently and securely with a local container registry. Customers will be able to download a container image from an external registry once, and then save a copy in their local registry for sharing among all the nodes in the cluster.

Connecting to an internal proxy rather than an external registry and downloading from a local cache rather than a remote server improves security and performance whenever a cluster node pulls a trusted image from the local registry. In addition, the lightweight CRI-O container runtime, designed specifically for Kubernetes, has been incorporated in the platform.

It also allows the simple deployment and management of long-running workloads through the Kubernetes Apps Workloads API. This API generally facilitates orchestration (self-healing, scaling, updates, termination) of common types of workloads.

Alibaba Cloud focuses on partnerships with SMEs at India Eco Summit

Cloud computing being a lucrative market, tech giants are now trying to capture the most of it, with Alibaba being the latest addition to the list.

Alibaba Cloud, the cloud computing arm of Alibaba Group, launched its new distribution channel programme at the India Eco Summit in New Delhi. The programme expects partners to bring in-depth technical knowledge to customers to build an open ecosystem among sales, technology and service partners. Under this channel strategy, Alibaba Cloud will also build specialised teams to focus on various market segments and sectors such as startups and online businesses, to provide customers with a single interface to partners in order to promote business growth.

India currently ranks third on the list of countries in APeJ (Asia Pacific excluding Japan) with US$ 2.12 billion spent on public cloud services. Alibaba Cloud provides products and services to clients in India across the e-commerce, gaming, media, retail and IoT sectors through an extensive network of distributors. The channel strategy further strengthens Alibaba Cloud's commitment to the Indian market.

"Alibaba Cloud has always been focused on empowering enterprises of different sizes to tap into opportunities in the digital age. With digital transformation poised to add close to US$ 154 billion to India's GDP, this is a great opportunity for us to do business in this country. We are excited about the launch of the distribution channel program as building a strong, collaborative partner ecosystem is essential to our growth strategy in India. By working with different partners, we will be able to bring our high quality products and services to customers in India to help them embrace the opportunities of digital transformation," said Alex Li, GM of Alibaba Cloud Asia Pacific.

To further strengthen this network and share business opportunities with its partners, Alibaba Cloud also announced that it will train 1,000 sales and technology personnel in India in the next six months.

In January this year, Alibaba Cloud set up its first India Data Center in Mumbai to fulfil the surging demand for cloud computing services among the fast-increasing number of India's small- and medium-sized businesses.

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